

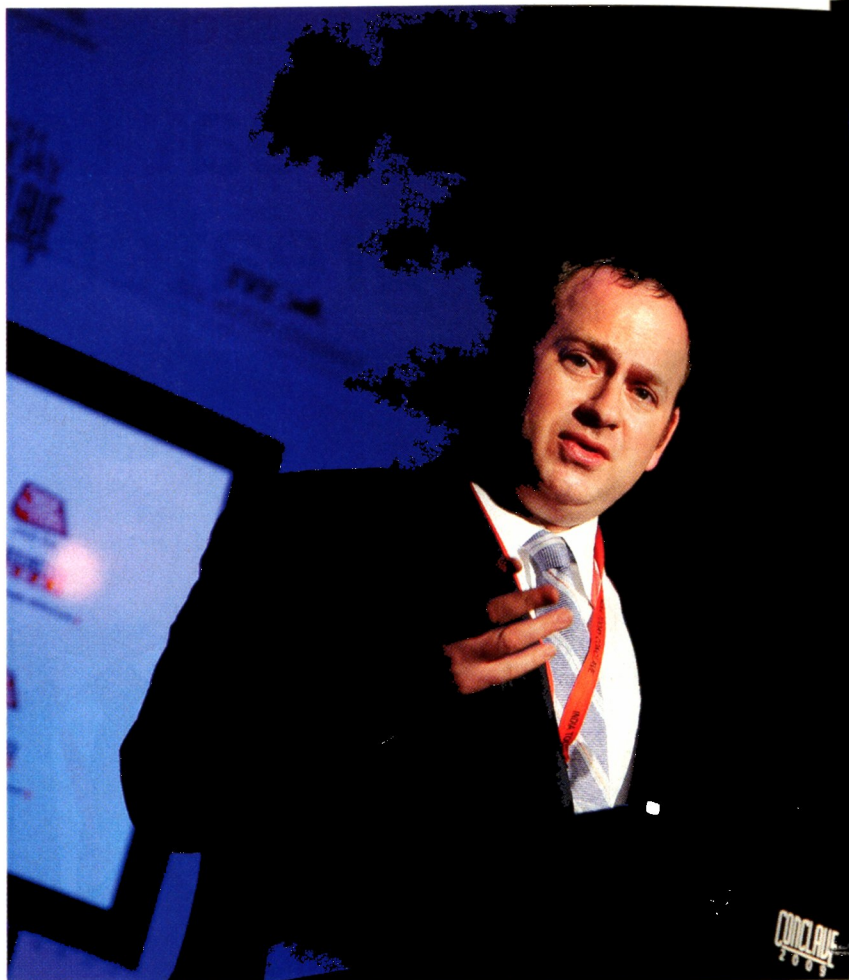
early stages of a major investigation.

The single change in the counter-terrorism effort has been the way the intelligence agencies and the police operate—seamlessly. They are sharing intelligence, there are strong interpersonal relationships and in every major case, meetings are held at the highest possible level of classification chaired by the national coordinator of terrorist investigations. Since 9/11 we have probably disrupted 11 or 12 attacks and have got 140 people in prison for terrorist offences, half of whom have pleaded guilty in court. This is unprecedented and I believe that a lot of this is because of the way in which there is complete cooperation now between the world of intelligence and that of law enforcement.

The government brought new laws which made hostile reconnaissance of a target part of terrorism. But 2004 was the real turning point because for the first time we found large groups of British citizens looking to mount mass casualty attacks within the UK.

In order to control the threat, we devoted enormous surveillance and other resources which led to a complete upgrading in the UK Police's capacity and capability. And that is something we have learned, that you have to invest heavily if you are going to achieve any success. You also need political support for a policy of pre-emption. They have to understand why you need laws which enable you to intervene early. And some of the most keenly fought political debates in the UK have been over counter-terrorism policing powers in the last couple of years. Laws need to capture things like people recruitment, other people going abroad for terrorism training, which never used to be a specific offence. To supplement conventional surveillance, we have some four million CCTV cameras, an automatic number-plate recognition system linked up to a national database which has proved useful in terror investigations. They have enabled us to deploy protective security rings of technology and have enabled us to investigate.

The key change in the last few years has been the development of an entirely complementary relationship between intelligence and law enforcement; that you need to have laws which fit the 21st century and not the 19th century. The judiciary need to be viciously impartial but also seriously robust. We need to raise the level of public debate and the media needs to take a slightly longer view. In the six-seven years that I headed counter-terrorism investigations, I never had political interference.



"Fund-raising is the main activity of terror groups"

DANIEL GLASER ACTING ASSISTANT SECRETARY (TERRORIST FINANCING), DEPARTMENT OF THE TREASURY, USA

(RIGHT; L-R) CLARKE, FORMER IB DIRECTOR AND SESSION CHAIRPERSON AJIT DOVAL AND GLASER

You would not normally expect to see someone from the financial community on a counter-terrorism panel but today any strategy to address international security is incomplete without a financial component. Virtually every UN Security Council resolution on international security over the past few years has included financial components—from terrorism to weapons proliferation, Iraq and North Korea. It has to do with the emergence of the international financial system in the 1990s which provided the ability to seam-